

D717

Student Teaching I in Elementary Education

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A student teacher placed in a school with a popular garden club receives a friend request on her personal social media from a parent of a student in her class. The parent often volunteers in the classroom. What is the best action?

- A. Block the parent and report them to the principal.
- B. Accept, since the parent volunteers.
- C. Accept but post only positive things.
- D. Politely decline and keep communication in school-approved channels.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

After an observation of a lesson taught with new tablets, a university supervisor tells a student teacher her directions were unclear, causing a slow start. The student teacher, who was a camp counselor for five years, feels the class was just tired. What is the most professional response?

- A. Explain that the class was tired, so the feedback does not apply.
- B. Point to her camp experience as proof she gives good directions.
- C. Agree and change nothing.
- D. Ask for an example of clearer directions, apply it in the next lesson, and share the result.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A supervisor writes that a student teacher “consistently seeks and applies feedback.” Which behavior earned this comment?

- A. She asks her mentor for one focus area each week and shows the change in later lessons.
- B. She never needs feedback.
- C. She explains why each suggestion does not fit her style.
- D. She thanks the mentor for feedback.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A student teacher takes over a third-grade class with a new reading nook. The posted rules include 12 items such as “No running,” “Don’t shout,” and “No hitting.” The mentor enforces them unevenly. What change best creates a positive environment?

- A. Work with the mentor and class to set 3–5 positively stated expectations, teach them, and apply them consistently.
- B. Keep the rules but enforce them more strictly.
- C. Move the rules to the reading nook.
- D. Add more rules to cover every behavior.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which rewrites “Don’t shout out answers” as a positively stated expectation?

- A. “Shouting will lose recess.”
- B. “Be good.”
- C. “No shouting ever.”
- D. “Raise your hand and wait to be called on.”

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

In the first week of student teaching in a school that recently won a state award, a candidate wants to take over all subjects immediately to impress her mentor. The mentor has a calm personality. What is the best plan?

- A. Let the award-winning school decide.
- B. Agree with the mentor on a schedule that starts with co-teaching and adds subjects over time.
- C. Only observe for the whole placement.
- D. Take over all subjects immediately.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A student teacher in a class that recently took a field trip to a farm is introducing equivalent fractions to third graders. She plans to explain the rule “multiply the top and bottom by the same number” and assign practice. The students are eight and nine years old. What change best fits their development?

- A. Count farm animals instead.
- B. Assign more practice problems.
- C. Start with fraction strips or paper folding so students see that $\frac{1}{2}$ and $\frac{2}{4}$ cover the same amount, then connect to the rule.
- D. Explain the rule more slowly.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A student can solve a problem only with a hint from the teacher, but not alone. Where is this task for the student?

- A. At the student’s independent level.
- B. In the student’s zone of proximal development.
- C. Beyond the student’s reach entirely.
- D. In the preoperational stage.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A student teacher finds a classic picture book on the class shelf that portrays Native Americans only in feathered headdresses speaking broken English. The book has a gold award seal and was donated by a retired teacher. What should she do?

- A. Use it because it has an award seal.
- B. Use it because it was donated by a teacher.
- C. Choose a book by a Native author that shows contemporary Native life, and discuss the concern with her mentor.
- D. Avoid all books about Native Americans.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

Students in a class that meets in a bright room with new standing desks used to write paragraphs on paper. Now they type the same paragraphs in a word processor and print them. The school's Wi-Fi was recently upgraded. At which SAMR level is this use?

- A. Substitution
- B. Modification
- C. Redefinition
- D. Augmentation, because the Wi-Fi is faster

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A teacher wants to move a writing task to the Redefinition level. Which change does that?

- A. Students type the story instead of handwriting it.
- B. Students publish a multimedia story and exchange feedback with a class in another country.
- C. Students use spell check.
- D. Any device use counts as redefinition.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A student teacher disagrees with how her mentor handles reading groups. The mentor has taught for 25 years and runs the school's book fair. What should she do first?

- A. Go straight to the principal.
- B. Complain to other teachers in the lounge.
- C. Ask the mentor for a private time to discuss the reading groups and share her idea respectfully.
- D. Stay silent, since a 25-year veteran is always right.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer D Concept 1

A student teacher ~~placed in a school with a popular garden club~~ receives a friend request on her personal social media from a parent of a student in her class. ~~The parent often volunteers in the classroom.~~ What is the best action?

Target word: best action **Decides:** Keep communication in professional channels.

A	Absolute language	An overreaction; a polite decline is enough.
B	Camouflage	Volunteering does not change boundary expectations.
C	Dropped element	Drops the boundary issue itself.
D	Correct	Maintains professional boundaries.

2. Answer D Concept 2

After an observation of a lesson ~~taught with new tablets~~, a university supervisor tells a student teacher her directions were unclear, causing a slow start. The student teacher, ~~who was a camp counselor for five years,~~ feels the class was just tired. What is the most professional response?

Target word: best response **Decides:** Accept, clarify, apply, and show the change.

A	Inverted operation	Defends instead of applying.
B	Camouflage	Past experience does not answer the observed evidence.
C	Dropped element	Drops the follow-through.
D	Correct	Shows openness and follow-through.

3. Answer A Concept 2 · transfer

A supervisor writes that a student teacher “consistently seeks and applies feedback.” Which behavior earned this comment?

Target word: reverse: behavior from the rating **Decides:** Asking for and applying feedback.

A	Correct	Seeks and applies feedback.
B	Absolute language	Every teacher benefits from feedback.
C	Inverted operation	Resists feedback.
D	Dropped element	Politeness without application.

4. Answer A Concept 3

A student teacher takes over a third-grade class ~~with a new reading nook~~. The posted rules include 12 items such as “No running,” “Don’t shout,” and “No hitting.” The mentor enforces them unevenly. What change best creates a positive environment?

Target word: best change **Decides:** Few, positive, taught, consistent expectations.

A	Correct	Clear, positive, taught, and consistent.
B	Dropped element	Drops positive phrasing and teaching.
C	Camouflage	Location does not fix the rules.
D	Inverted operation	Makes the list longer.

5. Answer D Concept 3 • transfer

Which rewrites “Don’t shout out answers” as a positively stated expectation?

Target word: positive restatement **Decides:** State what to do.

A	Adjacent category	A consequence, not an expectation.
B	Dropped element	Too vague; drops the specific behavior.
C	Absolute language	Still negative and absolute.
D	Correct	Tells students what to do.

6. Answer B Concept 4

In the first week of student teaching ~~in a school that recently won a state award~~, a candidate wants to take over all subjects immediately to impress her mentor. ~~The mentor has a calm personality.~~ What is the best plan?

Target word: best plan **Decides:** Responsibility is assumed gradually in agreement with the mentor.

A	Camouflage	The award does not set the schedule.
B	Correct	Gradual assumption builds skill and fits program expectations.
C	Dropped element	Never takes on responsibility.
D	Inverted operation	Skips the gradual build-up.

7. Answer C Concept 5

A student teacher ~~in a class that recently took a field trip to a farm~~ is introducing equivalent fractions to third graders. She plans to explain the rule “multiply the top and bottom by the same number” and assign practice. The students are eight and nine years old. What change best fits their development?

Target word: best change **Decides:** Concrete operational learners need hands-on models first.

A	Camouflage	Drops the fraction goal.
B	Adjacent category	Practice without a concrete basis.
C	Correct	Concrete experiences before abstract rules.
D	Dropped element	Still abstract only.

8. Answer B Concept 5 • transfer

A student can solve a problem only with a hint from the teacher, but not alone. Where is this task for the student?

Target word: locate the task **Decides:** Doable with help, not alone: the ZPD.

A	Inverted operation	Independent means doable alone.
B	Correct	The ZPD is what a learner can do with support.
C	Adjacent category	The student succeeds with help, so it is within reach.
D	Confusion set	A Piagetian stage, not a zone of support.

9. Answer C Concept 6

A student teacher finds a classic picture book on the class shelf that portrays Native Americans only in feathered headdresses speaking broken English. The book has a gold award seal and ~~was donated by a retired teacher~~. What should she do?

Target word: best action **Decides:** Stereotyped portrayal; choose authentic materials.

A	Adjacent category	Awards do not guarantee accurate portrayals.
B	Camouflage	The source does not decide quality.
C	Correct	Authentic voice and accurate portrayal.
D	Absolute language	Removes representation instead of improving it.

10. Answer A Concept 7

Students in a class ~~that meets in a bright room with new standing desks~~ used to write paragraphs on paper. Now they type the same paragraphs in a word processor and print them. ~~The school's Wi-Fi was recently upgraded.~~ At which SAMR level is this use?

Target word: SAMR level **Decides:** Tech replaces the tool with no functional change.

A	Correct	The task is the same; only the tool changed.
B	Adjacent category	Modification redesigns the task.
C	Inverted operation	Redefinition creates tasks not possible before.
D	Camouflage	Network speed does not change the task.

11. Answer B Concept 7 • transfer

A teacher wants to move a writing task to the Redefinition level. Which change does that?

Target word: pick redefinition **Decides:** A task not possible without the technology.

A	Confusion set	Substitution.
B	Correct	A new task not possible before the technology.
C	Adjacent category	Augmentation.
D	Absolute language	Most device use is substitution or augmentation.

12. Answer C Concept 8

A student teacher disagrees with how her mentor handles reading groups. The mentor ~~has taught for 25 years and runs the school's book fair~~. What should she do first?

Target word: first step **Decides:** Raise the concern directly and privately with the mentor.

A	Inverted operation	Escalates before talking with the mentor.
B	Adjacent category	Venting is not professional problem solving.
C	Correct	Direct, private, professional communication comes first.
D	Absolute language	Experience does not rule out respectful discussion.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	7	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	7	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	7	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	6	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	2	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	7	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Professional ethics and boundaries	Educator ethics codes call for professional relationships with students and families: no private social media connections, no favoritism or gifts that create obligations, and honest records.	Thinking friendly online contact with students or families is harmless if the intent is good.	A request to connect, text, or exchange favors outside school channels.
2	Responding to feedback	A professional disposition means listening, asking clarifying questions, applying the feedback promptly, and showing the change, rather than defending or explaining away.	Arguing with feedback or agreeing and then changing nothing.	A supervisor's observation comment.
3	Positive classroom expectations	Use a few (3-5) clear, positively stated expectations that are taught, practiced, and reinforced consistently.	A long list of "don't" rules enforced unevenly.	A classroom rules chart.
4	Gradual assumption of responsibility	Student teachers take on planning and teaching gradually (co-teaching, then lead teaching of some subjects, then full days) in agreement with the mentor and program.	Taking over all teaching on day one, or observing for the whole placement.	How much of the teaching day the candidate leads, and when.
5	Developmentally appropriate instruction	Most elementary students (about 7-11) think concretely: they learn abstract ideas best through hands-on materials and examples, with scaffolds inside their zone of proximal development.	Teaching through abstract explanation alone because students are old enough to listen.	An abstract concept taught to young children.
6	Choosing culturally relevant materials	Choose materials with authentic voices, accurate and non-stereotyped portrayals, and a range of cultures shown in everyday as well as historical contexts.	Using a book because it is a classic without checking its portrayals.	Reviewing a text or resource before teaching.
7	The SAMR model for technology	Substitution (tech replaces a tool, no change), Augmentation (substitution plus improvement), Modification (task significantly redesigned), Redefinition (new tasks not possible before).	Thinking any use of a device transforms learning.	A description of how technology changes a task.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
8	Collaborative professional communication	Raise concerns directly and privately with the person involved (usually the mentor) first, then with the university supervisor if unresolved, using professional channels.	Venting about the mentor to colleagues or online, or going over the mentor's head first.	A disagreement in the placement.

Course scope (public description): Student Teaching I is the first part of a two-part series and is a mandatory course for all candidates seeking initial licensure. This course provides a supervised classroom experience in a real-world setting, allowing candidates to demonstrate and reflect upon professional ethics and dispositions, collaborate with experienced teachers, and implement instructional strategies rooted in students' learning and developmental patterns. Building on the responsibilities and skills developed in Advanced Clinical, candidates will receive ongoing feedback through observations and evaluations. Feedback will encourage candidates to reflect on their commitment to professional practices as educators, analyze and adjust teaching methods, and explore new teaching materials and methods that are culturally relevant. Additionally, the course features synchronous learning sessions that delve into communication and collaboration, accepting feedback, creating positive learning environments, and technology and online learning. Candidates must attend the required synchronous learning sessions in addition to their classroom placement.